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SSH Brute Force - Automated Credential Attack Response

HIGH **APPROVED** Version v1 | PB-SSH-0001

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[META] Playbook Metadata

Playbook ID	PB-SSH-0001	Version	v1
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[THREAT] Threat Context

Source IP	192.168.1.100	Destination Port	22
Protocol	TCP	Attack Type	SSH_AUTH_FAILURE
Threat Score	87.3 / 100		
Confidence Score	0.873	Severity Tier	HIGH

[MITRE] MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique ID	T1110.001	Tactic	Credential Access
Technique Name	Brute Force: Password Guessing		
ATT&CK Reference	T1110.001 — Brute Force: Password Guessing ATT&CK Reference: https://attack.mitre.org/techniques/T1110/001/		

[PLAYBOOK] Playbook Content

Incident Response Playbook

Executive Summary

This playbook describes the full incident response workflow for a detected threat campaign.

Phase 1: Identification

- Step 1: Perform analysis task 1 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.2.
- Step 2: Perform analysis task 2 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.3.
- Step 3: Perform analysis task 3 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.4.
- Step 4: Perform analysis task 4 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.5.
- Step 5: Perform analysis task 5 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.6.
- Step 6: Perform analysis task 6 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.7.
- Step 7: Perform analysis task 7 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.8.
- Step 8: Perform analysis task 8 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.9.
- Step 9: Perform analysis task 9 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.10.
- Step 10: Perform analysis task 10 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.11.
- Step 11: Perform analysis task 11 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.12.
- Step 12: Perform analysis task 12 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.13.
- Step 13: Perform analysis task 13 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.14.
- Step 14: Perform analysis task 14 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.15.
- Step 15: Perform analysis task 15 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.16.
- Step 16: Perform analysis task 16 in phase 1. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.17.

Phase 2: Detection

1. Step 1: Perform analysis task 1 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.2.
2. Step 2: Perform analysis task 2 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.3.
3. Step 3: Perform analysis task 3 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.4.
4. Step 4: Perform analysis task 4 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.5.
5. Step 5: Perform analysis task 5 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.6.
6. Step 6: Perform analysis task 6 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.7.
7. Step 7: Perform analysis task 7 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.8.
8. Step 8: Perform analysis task 8 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.9.
9. Step 9: Perform analysis task 9 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.10.
10. Step 10: Perform analysis task 10 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.11.
11. Step 11: Perform analysis task 11 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.12.
12. Step 12: Perform analysis task 12 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.13.
13. Step 13: Perform analysis task 13 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.14.
14. Step 14: Perform analysis task 14 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.15.
15. Step 15: Perform analysis task 15 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.16.
16. Step 16: Perform analysis task 16 in phase 2. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.17.

Phase 3: Containment

1. Step 1: Perform analysis task 1 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.2.
2. Step 2: Perform analysis task 2 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.3.
3. Step 3: Perform analysis task 3 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.4.
4. Step 4: Perform analysis task 4 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.5.
5. Step 5: Perform analysis task 5 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.6.
6. Step 6: Perform analysis task 6 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.7.
7. Step 7: Perform analysis task 7 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.8.
8. Step 8: Perform analysis task 8 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.9.
9. Step 9: Perform analysis task 9 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.10.
10. Step 10: Perform analysis task 10 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.11.
11. Step 11: Perform analysis task 11 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.12.
12. Step 12: Perform analysis task 12 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.13.
13. Step 13: Perform analysis task 13 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.14.
14. Step 14: Perform analysis task 14 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.15.

15. Step 15: Perform analysis task 15 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.16.
16. Step 16: Perform analysis task 16 in phase 3. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.17.

Phase 4: Eradication

1. Step 1: Perform analysis task 1 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.2.
2. Step 2: Perform analysis task 2 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.3.
3. Step 3: Perform analysis task 3 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.4.
4. Step 4: Perform analysis task 4 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.5.
5. Step 5: Perform analysis task 5 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.6.
6. Step 6: Perform analysis task 6 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.7.
7. Step 7: Perform analysis task 7 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.8.
8. Step 8: Perform analysis task 8 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.9.
9. Step 9: Perform analysis task 9 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.10.
10. Step 10: Perform analysis task 10 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.11.
11. Step 11: Perform analysis task 11 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.12.
12. Step 12: Perform analysis task 12 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.13.
13. Step 13: Perform analysis task 13 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.14.
14. Step 14: Perform analysis task 14 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.15.
15. Step 15: Perform analysis task 15 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.16.
16. Step 16: Perform analysis task 16 in phase 4. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.17.

Phase 5: Recovery

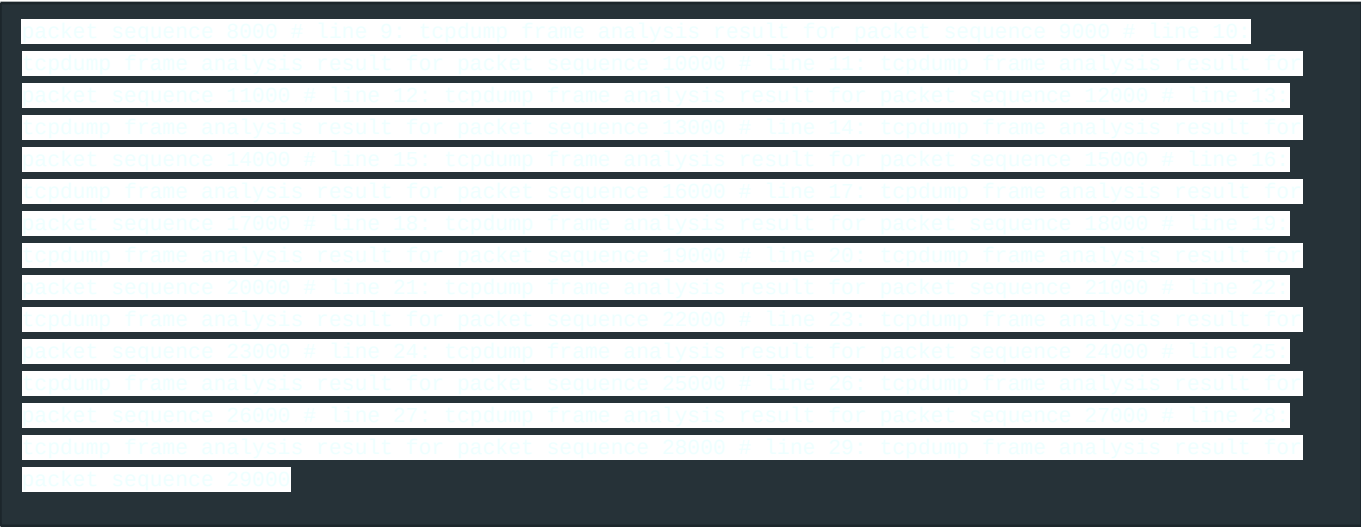
1. Step 1: Perform analysis task 1 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.2.
2. Step 2: Perform analysis task 2 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.3.
3. Step 3: Perform analysis task 3 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.4.
4. Step 4: Perform analysis task 4 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.5.
5. Step 5: Perform analysis task 5 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.6.
6. Step 6: Perform analysis task 6 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.7.
7. Step 7: Perform analysis task 7 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.8.
8. Step 8: Perform analysis task 8 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.9.
9. Step 9: Perform analysis task 9 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.10.
10. Step 10: Perform analysis task 10 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.11.
11. Step 11: Perform analysis task 11 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.12.

- 12. Step 12: Perform analysis task 12 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.13.
- 13. Step 13: Perform analysis task 13 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.14.
- 14. Step 14: Perform analysis task 14 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.15.
- 15. Step 15: Perform analysis task 15 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.16.
- 16. Step 16: Perform analysis task 16 in phase 5. Review all log entries from source 10.0.0.17.

IOC Reference Table

Type	Value	Severity	First Seen
IP	10.0.0.1	HIGH	2026-07-01
IP	10.0.0.2	HIGH	2026-07-02
IP	10.0.0.3	HIGH	2026-07-03
IP	10.0.0.4	HIGH	2026-07-04
IP	10.0.0.5	HIGH	2026-07-05
IP	10.0.0.6	HIGH	2026-07-06
IP	10.0.0.7	HIGH	2026-07-07
IP	10.0.0.8	HIGH	2026-07-08
IP	10.0.0.9	HIGH	2026-07-09
IP	10.0.0.10	HIGH	2026-07-10
IP	10.0.0.11	HIGH	2026-07-11

Forensic Notes



[AI] AI Threat Narrative

AI Analysis

This campaign exhibits classic brute force patterns targeting port 22.

Key Indicators

- 450 login attempts in 60 seconds
- Source: single IP rotating usernames

[IDS] Snort IDS Rule

```
alert tcp $EXTERNAL_NET any -> $HOME_NET 22 (msg:"ET SCAN Potential SSH Scan OUTBOUND"; flow:established,to_server; content:"SSH-"; depth:4; threshold:type both,track by_src,count 5,seconds 120; classtype:attempted-recon; sid:2001219; rev:20; metadata:affected_product Any,attack_target Server,created_at 2010_07_30,cve CVE-2023-12345,deployment Perimeter,signature_severity Major,tag Scanning,updated_at 2026_07_30;) alert tcp any any -> any 22 (msg:"SSH Brute Force Login Attempt"; flow:established,to_server; content:"SSH-2.0"; depth:7; threshold:type threshold,track by_src,count 10,seconds 60; classtype:attempted-admin; sid:9001001; rev:3;) alert tcp $HOME_NET any -> $EXTERNAL_NET any (msg:"Suspicious outbound SSH tunnel established after brute force"; flow:established,from_server; content:"channel open"; pcre:"/^SSH-[12]/"; classtype:trojan-activity; sid:9001002; rev:1;)
```

[SIGMA] Sigma Detection Rule



```
title: SSH Brute Force Attack Detection id: 8fef5e0a-a834-4f3c-a9b7-0c4e1f2d3e56 status: experimental description:
Detects multiple failed SSH authentication attempts from the same source IP references: -
https://attack.mitre.org/techniques/T1110/001/ -
https://www.elastic.co/guide/en/siem/guide/current/ssh-brute-force.html author: PhantomNet Sentinel Auto-Generator
date: 2026/07/30 tags: - attack.credential_access - attack.t1110.001 - attack.brute_force logsource: category:
authentication product: linux detection: selection: EventID: 4625 LogonType: 10 SubjectUserName|contains: '*'
condition: selection | count() > 10 by SourceAddress within 60s falsepositives: - Legitimate automated login tools
with misconfigured credentials - Penetration testing activities level: high fields: - SourceAddress - TargetUserName
- WorkstationName - LogonFailureReason
```

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